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RITUAL ACTS
Sakshi leads wrestlers to immerse their medals in Haridwar, May 30; Singh performs *arti* in Ayodhya, June 4

OC is also said to have made two major recommendations on how to proceed. The first was to set up an ad hoc committee to replace the current one to run the day-to-day operations of the federation and to hold a transparent election for the new executive committee at the earliest. The other was to ask Delhi Police to investigate the charges of sexual harassment.

It was on April 21 that the initial police complaint against Singh was registered. Narendra Hooda says it took the victims over four hours just to get a receipt, time they spent waiting on the steps of the Connaught Place Police Station in Delhi. The wrestlers listed 10 complaints against the WFI chief, but no FIR was registered. This led to the wrestlers submitting a petition in the Supreme Court. "It was only after a clear court order came that police registered an FIR on April 28," says Hooda. On the same day, the government announced the formation of the Indian Olympic Association's (IOA) ad hoc committee to run the WFI till a new one was elected.

On April 28, two FIRs were lodged against Singh—one under the Protection of Children from Sexual Offences (PoCSO) Act and another under Sections 354 (assault or criminal force to woman with intent to outrage her modesty), 354A (sexual harassment), 354D (stalking) and 34 (common intention) of the Indian Penal Code that carry a jail term of one to three years. Under PoCSO, Singh could face imprisonment for a term not less than five years but which may extend to seven years, and also be liable to pay a fine. The offence is also non-bailable. The FIR reduced the original 10 complaints to seven. These listed 14 incidents of sexual harassment and inappropriate touching: three in 2012; one in 2016; two in 2017; one each in 2018, 2019 and 2021; and five in 2022, including one where the victim was said to be a minor when the alleged offence was committed.

According to these complaints, Singh appears to be a serial offender. One complainant has accused him of molesting her during the World Junior Asian Wrestling Championship in Bulgaria in August 2022, and later of seeking "sexual favour" at his residence in return for WFI bearing the medical expenses for her injury. Another accuser said that during the 2016 Olympic qualifiers in Mongolia, Singh placed his hand on her breast and groped her and touched her stomach repeatedly in a restaurant. A third wrestler detailed a 2018 incident in Kyrgyzstan when she was on the mat and Singh pulled up her T-shirt and touched her breast and stomach "on the pretext of examining/checking my breathing". Other incidents from 2022 recount forceful physical contact, including Singh sliding his hand down the shoulder and inappropriately touching a female wrestler during a team photograph. At least on four occasions, the harassment took place at Singh's residence/WFI office. All the complainants maintained that fear of reprisal and concerns about their

Going by the 14 incidents of sexual offences over a decade alleged in the seven complaints, the picture emerges of a serial offender